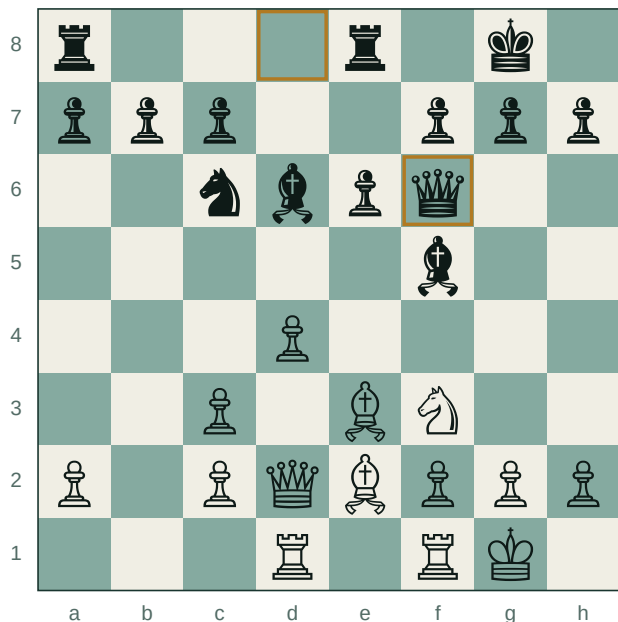


Trapping a piece: White, move 12

Trapping a piece

White to move



Previous move: 11...Qf6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

12. Bg5 Qg6 13. Nh4 h6 14. Nxg6

12.Bg5 The bishop moves from e3 to g5. Recorded reply: **12...Qg6**.

13.Nh4 The knight moves from f3 to h4. From h4 it attacks queen on g6 and bishop on f5. Recorded reply: **13...h6**.

14.Nxg6 The knight captures the queen on g6.

At the end, nominal material is White 35 / Black 26 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from +0 to +9. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attacked piece is not trapped if it can give check, trade itself favorably, or open an escape through a sacrifice.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A trapped piece lacks safe retreat squares. Winning it usually requires restricting its routes before attacking it, or forcing it into a cage.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace every plausible escape square for the target, including captures and counterchecks. Then find the move that closes the remaining route.

The defending king is on g8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.